

Lab 3 Tutorial: User Input and Stack Navigation

This comprehensive tutorial covers essential React Native concepts for building interactive mobile applications:

1. **Handling User Input & Forms** - Working with TextInput and form validation
 2. **Introduction to Stack Navigation** - Overview of Stack Navigator
 3. **Navigating Between Screens** - Implementing Stack navigation in your app
 4. **Passing Data Using Navigation** - Sharing data between screens
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How to Run the Project

Follow these steps to set up and run the Lab 3 project:

Step 1: Download the Repository

Download the project from GitHub:

- Repository URL: <https://github.com/neonbranch/CPSC-357-Lab>

Step 2: Extract and Navigate

1. Extract the downloaded files
2. Navigate to the **lab3** folder
3. Then navigate to the **expo-app-v2** folder

```
cd lab3
cd expo-app-v2
```

Step 3: Install Dependencies

Install all required npm packages:

```
npm install
```

Step 4: Start the Expo Development Server

Run the Expo development server:

```
npx expo start
```

1. Handling User Input & Forms

Login Form Example

Here's a complete login form example that demonstrates handling user input with validation:

```
import { useState } from 'react';
import {
  View,
  Text,
  TextInput,
  Button,
  StyleSheet,
  Alert,
} from 'react-native';
import { useNavigation } from '@react-navigation/native';

export default function LoginForm() {
  const navigation = useNavigation();
  const [email, setEmail] = useState('');
  const [password, setPassword] = useState('');

  const handleSubmit = () => {
    // Validation: Check if fields are empty
    if (!email || !password) {
      Alert.alert('Error', 'Please fill in all fields');
      return;
    }

    // Length validation: min 5, max 20 characters
    if (email.length < 5 || email.length > 20) {
      Alert.alert('Error', 'Email must be between 5 and 20 characters');
      return;
    }
    if (password.length < 5 || password.length > 20) {
      Alert.alert('Error', 'Password must be between 5 and 20 characters');
      return;
    }

    // Assume: Login is successful
    Alert.alert('Success', `Welcome, ${email}!`);

    // Navigate to Home with email and loginStatus
    navigation.navigate('Home', {
      email: email,
      loginStatus: true
    });

    // Reset form
    setEmail('');
    setPassword('');
  };
}
```

```
return (
  <View style={styles.container}>
    <Text style={styles.title}>Login</Text>

    <Text style={styles.label}>Email</Text>
    <TextInput
      style={styles.input}
      placeholder="Enter your email"
      keyboardType="email-address"
      autoCapitalize="none"
      value={email}
      onChangeText={setEmail}
    />

    <Text style={styles.label}>Password</Text>
    <TextInput
      style={styles.input}
      placeholder="Enter your password"
      secureTextEntry={true}
      value={password}
      onChangeText={setPassword}
    />

    <Button title="Login" onPress={handleSubmit} />
  </View>
);
}

const styles = StyleSheet.create({
  container: {
    flex: 1,
    padding: 20,
    backgroundColor: '#fff',
  },
  title: {
    fontSize: 28,
    fontWeight: 'bold',
    marginBottom: 30,
    textAlign: 'center',
  },
  label: {
    fontSize: 16,
    fontWeight: '600',
    marginBottom: 8,
    marginTop: 15,
  },
  input: {
    height: 50,
    borderWidth: 1,
    borderColor: '#ddd',
    borderRadius: 8,
    paddingHorizontal: 15,
    fontSize: 16,
```

```
        backgroundColor: '#f9f9f9',  
      },  
    ));
```

Key Features of this Login Form:

- Uses `useState` to manage email and password state
- Uses `useNavigation` hook to navigate after successful login
- Includes form validation (empty fields and length checks)
- Uses `secureTextEntry` for password field
- Uses `keyboardType="email-address"` for email input
- Resets form fields after submission
- Passes data to the next screen via navigation params

2. Introduction to Stack Navigation

Navigation allows users to move between different screens in your app. React Navigation is the most popular navigation library for React Native.

Stack Navigator

The Stack Navigator navigates between screens like a stack (last-in-first-out). It's common for hierarchical navigation.

Characteristics:

- Push new screens on top
- Pop screens to go back
- Shows header with back button
- Good for: Detail screens, forms, authentication flows

Navigation Container

All navigators must be wrapped in a `NavigationContainer`:

```
import { NavigationContainer } from '@react-navigation/native';  
  
export default function App() {  
  return (  
    <NavigationContainer>  
      { /* Your navigator here */ }  
    </NavigationContainer>  
  );  
}
```

3. Navigating Between Screens

Simple Stack Navigation Example with Passing Data

Here's a complete example showing Stack Navigation with data passing:

```
import 'react-native-gesture-handler';
import React from 'react';
import { View, Text, Button, StyleSheet } from 'react-native';
import { NavigationContainer } from '@react-navigation/native';
import { createNativeStackNavigator } from '@react-navigation/native-stack';
import { useNavigation, useRoute } from '@react-navigation/native';

const Stack = createNativeStackNavigator();

// Screen 1: Home Screen - Passes data to Details
function HomeScreen() {
  const navigation = useNavigation();

  const goToDetails = () => {
    // Navigate and pass data
    navigation.navigate('Details', {
      userName: 'John Doe',
      userId: 123
    });
  };

  return (
    <View style={styles.container}>
      <Text style={styles.title}>Home Screen</Text>
      <Button title="Go to Details" onPress={goToDetails} />
    </View>
  );
}

// Screen 2: Details Screen - Receives data
function DetailsScreen() {
  const route = useRoute();
  const navigation = useNavigation();

  // Get data from route params
  const userName = route.params?.userName || 'Guest';
  const userId = route.params?.userId || 0;

  return (
    <View style={styles.container}>
      <Text style={styles.title}>Details Screen</Text>
      <Text>User Name: {userName}</Text>
      <Text>User ID: {userId}</Text>
      <Button title="Go Back" onPress={() => navigation.goBack()} />
    </View>
  );
}
```

```
// Main App Component
export default function App() {
  return (
    <NavigationContainer>
      <Stack.Navigator>
        <Stack.Screen name="Home" component={HomeScreen} />
        <Stack.Screen name="Details" component={DetailsScreen} />
      </Stack.Navigator>
    </NavigationContainer>
  );
}

const styles = StyleSheet.create({
  container: {
    flex: 1,
    justifyContent: 'center',
    alignItems: 'center',
    padding: 20,
  },
  title: {
    fontSize: 24,
    fontWeight: 'bold',
    marginBottom: 20,
  },
});
```

Key Points:

- `useNavigation()` hook is used to navigate between screens
- `useRoute()` hook is used to receive data from previous screen
- Data is passed using the second parameter of `navigation.navigate()`
- Use optional chaining (`?.`) to safely access route params

4. Passing Data Using Navigation

How to Pass Data

Step 1: Pass data when navigating

```
import { useNavigation } from '@react-navigation/native';

function HomeScreen() {
  const navigation = useNavigation();

  const handlePress = () => {
    // Pass data as second parameter
    navigation.navigate('Details', {
      userName: 'John Doe',
      userId: 123
    });
  };
}
```

```
};

return (
  <Button title="Go to Details" onPress={handlePress} />
);
}
```

Step 2: Receive data in the destination screen

```
import { useRoute } from '@react-navigation/native';

function DetailsScreen() {
  const route = useRoute();

  // Get data using optional chaining
  const userName = route.params?.userName || 'Guest';
  const userId = route.params?.userId || 0;

  return (
    <View>
      <Text>Name: {userName}</Text>
      <Text>ID: {userId}</Text>
    </View>
  );
}
```

Navigation Methods

```
// Navigate to a screen
navigation.navigate('ScreenName');

// Navigate with data
navigation.navigate('Details', { userName: 'John', userId: 123 });

// Go back
navigation.goBack();
```

Summary

This tutorial covered essential concepts for building interactive React Native applications:

- **User Input & Forms:** Handling text input and form validation
- **Stack Navigation:** Understanding and implementing Stack Navigator
- **Screen Navigation:** Moving between different screens using Stack Navigator
- **Data Passing:** Sharing data between screens using navigation params

Next Steps

- Practice building forms with validation
- Create a multi-screen app with Stack navigation
- Explore advanced Stack navigation patterns
- Study React Navigation documentation: <https://reactnavigation.org>

Additional Resources

- [React Navigation Documentation](#)
- [React Native TextInput](#)